

SPRINGFIELD POLICE DEPARTMENT

State of Illinois

ILLINOIS TRAFFIC CRASH REPORT

Report #: SPD-2024-05678

Date of Crash: March 15, 2024

Time: 15:45 (3:45 PM)

Jurisdiction: Springfield
PD

CRASH LOCATION

Street / Intersection

Main Street at 5th Avenue

Direction of Travel (V1)

Eastbound on Main St.

City

Springfield, Sangamon County

Traffic Control

Traffic Signal — Red for V1

Road Surface

Dry — Asphalt

Weather

Clear, daylight

VEHICLE 1 (STRUCK)

Driver

John A. Smith

Address

742 Evergreen Terrace, Springfield, IL 62704

DOB

06/12/1985

Phone

(555) 234-5678

DL#

S550-1234-5678 (IL)

Plate

IL ABC-1234

Vehicle

2021 Toyota Camry LE — Silver

VIN

4T1B11HK5MU123456

Vehicle 1 Occupants:

Seat	Name	Age	Injury Status	Transported
Driver	John A. Smith	38	Complaint of Pain	Refused — Sought own treatment
Front Pass.	Maria Smith	36	Complaint of Pain	Refused — Sought own treatment
Rear Pass.	Elena Rodriguez	29	Complaint of Neck Pain	Transported by EMS to Springfield General

Total Occupants in Vehicle 1: 3 (1 driver + 2 passengers)

EMS Response: Springfield Fire/EMS Unit 7 responded to scene at 15:52. All three occupants of Vehicle 1 were evaluated at the scene. Elena Rodriguez (rear passenger) was transported to Springfield General Hospital for further evaluation. Driver and front passenger refused transport and stated they would seek their own medical treatment.

VEHICLE 2 (STRIKING)

Driver	Address
Robert J. Williams	1456 Oak Park Drive, Springfield, IL 62703
DOB	Phone
11/28/1978	(555) 876-5432
DL#	Plate
W789-5678-9012 (IL)	IL XYZ-9876
Vehicle	Insurance
2019 Ford F-150 XLT — Black	State Farm #SF-7891234

Vehicle 2 Occupants: 1 (driver only, no passengers)

Injury Status: No apparent injury. Refused medical evaluation.

CITATIONS ISSUED

Citation #	Driver	Violation	Statute
CT-2024-34567	Robert J. Williams	Following Too Closely	625 ILCS 5/11-710
CT-2024-34568	Robert J. Williams	Failure to Reduce Speed	625 ILCS 5/11-601

OFFICER NARRATIVE

On March 15, 2024, at approximately 1545 hours, I, Officer Miguel Rodriguez (Badge #2847), responded to a reported traffic crash at the intersection of Main Street and 5th Avenue.

Upon arrival at 1553 hours, I observed Vehicle 1 (2021 Toyota Camry, silver) stopped in the intersection facing eastbound with significant rear-end damage. Vehicle 2 (2019 Ford F-150, black) was approximately 15 feet behind Vehicle 1 with front-end damage to the bumper, hood, and grille. Both vehicles were blocking the eastbound lane of Main Street.

I made contact with the driver of Vehicle 1, **John A. Smith**, who stated he was stopped at a red light when he felt a sudden impact from behind. Mr. Smith reported that he and his **two passengers — his wife Maria Smith (front passenger) and their friend Elena Rodriguez (rear passenger)** — all experienced immediate neck and back pain upon impact. All three occupants of Vehicle 1 were evaluated at the scene by Springfield Fire/EMS Unit 7. Ms. Rodriguez was transported to Springfield General Hospital complaining of severe neck pain and numbness in her left arm.

The driver of Vehicle 2, **Robert J. Williams**, stated he was traveling eastbound on Main Street and did not see Vehicle 1 stopped at the red light in time to stop. Mr. Williams estimated his speed at approximately 30-35 mph at the time of impact. He stated he was adjusting his radio and looked up to see Vehicle 1 stopped ahead with insufficient distance to brake.

Witness **David Chen**, a pedestrian on the southeast corner of the intersection, corroborated Mr. Smith's account, stating that Vehicle 1 was stopped at the light when Vehicle 2 struck it from behind without apparent braking.

Based on physical evidence, witness statements, and driver interviews, I determined that Vehicle 2 (Williams) was the proximate cause of the crash due to failure to maintain safe following distance and failure to reduce speed to avoid a collision. Two citations were issued to Mr. Williams as noted above.

Vehicle 1 was towed from the scene by Springfield Towing (555-111-2222). Vehicle 2 was driven from the scene by Mr. Williams. Scene was cleared at 1645 hours.

WITNESSES

David Chen — 890 Elm Street, Apt 4B, Springfield, IL 62704 | Phone: (555) 345-6789
Statement: Observed Vehicle 2 strike Vehicle 1 from behind while V1 was stopped at red light. Did not observe V2 attempt to brake before impact.

ESTIMATED DAMAGE

Vehicle	Damage Area	Severity	Est. Damage	Towed
V1 — 2021 Toyota Camry	Rear — Bumper, trunk lid, tail lights	Moderate	\$8,500	Yes
V2 — 2019 Ford F-150	Front — Bumper, hood, grille	Minor-Moderate	\$4,200	No

Investigating Officer: Miguel Rodriguez, Badge #2847
Report Date: March 15, 2024
Supervisor Review: Sgt. Patricia Hayes, Badge #1203 — Approved March 16, 2024